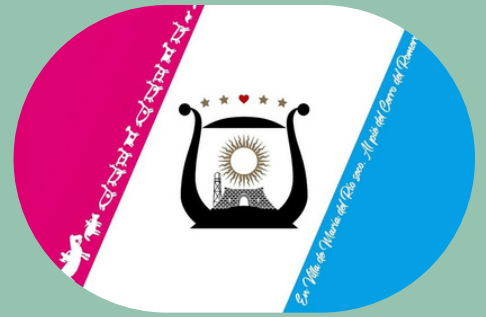


Villa de María

Del Rio Seco



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FIRST INHABITANTS

History

Before the town's foundation, Villa de María was a habited zone by two types of indigenous: sanavirones, that were at the east of the zone, and comechingones, which were in the mountain area, and the ones who left their characteristic imprinted in the eaves of Cerro Colorado.



In 1615, this place was founded as “Río Seco Place”

in 1637 as “Quillovil” or “Río Seco Quillovit”

in 1797, the place was known as Quilloamira or Quillovil, that meant dead water or dry river in aboriginal language.

TOWN'S FOUNDATION

History

since before the foundation, there existed an old chapel in Cerro del Romero, but its transformation to a Water Fountain and Prison are close to 1760 and 1768 respectively. Then, it turned into a place for the general command of the northern border of the province of Cordoba.

The location was founded in 1796 because of the Cordoba governor, who gave the order, and who took as base the population that was living around the chapel and the old post where so many processors passed through, in their campaigns to the north of the country and toward the High Peru.

In 1760, the old oratory of Cerro del Romero was transformed into a water fountain.

In 1768, the same place became a prison.

In 1796, the town was officially founded by order of the governor of Córdoba, based on the population of the temple and the old post office.

CAPTIVE VIRGIN

History

Villa de María (current name), it is marked by historic events like the attack of an indigenous malón (unexpected attack of aboriginals) in 1748, where they took the decision of taking an icon of the place and people: that was called Virgen del Rosario, which was recovered in a memorable fight, and, subsequently, it is known as “Virgen Cautivita” (Cautiva means captive in English).

The year was 1748 when an indigenous malón got to the place razing everything they found in their way and decided that they must take as a trophy the image of the Virgen del Rosario, that was being venerated in her chapel. Everything that these indigenous found in the countryside or the people’s houses was killed or captured without anyone putting up resistance. The land was devastated everywhere. Their bad strength came up to the temple where this virgin was venerated, and then they destroyed the door provided with iron sheets and bars with an ax.



The captain Francisco de la Barreda, his guide Landriel, and their men got the notice about the horrible fact, and, they decided to start a persecution against indigenous, who were divided in two groups, which could make that the tropes that were following them feel lost for a few moments. But at the end, they could find the indigenous people and get the saint image of the Virgin back, which right after the first moment was returned to her chapel.

Our Virgen del Rosario is known since then as “La Cautivita”.

Every year, when the Patron Saint Festivities are celebrated, a certain part of the population recreate this historical conflict, which is called the “The Rescue of the Virgin”, and it means an entertainment for little kids and grown people.

PANCHO RAMÍREZ

History

The historic facts in Rio Seco are too many, and that's how we talk about the year 1821, when the supreme entrerriano that was known as Pancho Ramirez (even though his real name was Francisco) was being persecuted by Juan Bautista Bustos, that was the governor of Cordoba at the moment, and who ordered to Bedoya, his substitute governor, keep the trace.

His persecution started at Cordoba, that was in charge of Bustos, and when Pancho got to San Francisco del Chañar -a town that is not so large-, he was intercepted by a patrol, that was out precisely to intercept him and was coming since the fort in Rio Seco, that was also commanded by the Colonel Francisco de Bedoya.



After the combat the morning of July 10th, Ramirez gave up having a last wish: he wanted to come back to rescue his wife Delfina.

He is murdered and decapitated in the same place, and his head was moved to the town and exposed in it. That same place now has a monolith, remembering him, and it is a few meters from the Cerro del Romero.

LEOPOLDO LUGONES

History

Leopoldo Lugones (narrator, poet, journalist, historian, librarian, pedagogue, teacher, translator, biographer, philologist, theosophist, diplomat, politician and nationalist sympathizer) was born in our town, on June 13th of 1874 (remembered today as the National Writer's Day), and he died in Buenos Aires, in 1938.

Lugones was a man of vast culture, and the greatest exponent of argentinian modernism, and one of the most influential and important writers of Spanish language literature. For him, language was one of the most important nationalist issues.

He spent his childhood and adolescence in Villa de María, and after a little time in Santiago del Estero, neighboring province, he established himself in Buenos Aires, in 1895.

After working in not so big jobs, he started to work in the National Teachers Library, which took him to live in Europe, and then he decided to reside in Paris between 1911 and 1914, but he decided to come back right after the blast of the First World War.

He won the National Literature Award in 1926, and right two years after that he founded the Argentinian Writers Society.



Jorge Luis Borges was one of the first persons to position Leopoldo Lugones as one of the most essential writers of argentinian literature.

Unfortunately, he killed himself drinking whiskey with cyanide after a depression caused by a deep emotional crisis that was provoked supposedly by Lugones support to the 1930 coup d'état and the deception this dictatorship brought. Even then, there are not so many certain facts, because there are so many speculations about why he killed himself: there are rumors about love deception, social shame or antidemocratic repudiation. When he died, he left over the table of his house a whiskey bottle that was in the middle, and a letter that said: "I can not finish the book about Roca. Stop".

Lugones is an icon of our culture, not talking only about the town and Córdoba, because we need to talk about Argentina too: he is one of the most important people we will ever have. Thanks to his literary innovation, the genre's diversity that he knew how to convey, his intellectual influence that he left for the next generations, his political and social help to form new generations has given so much to our national culture, that trying to not make him a key national piece of our history is even impossible.

Lugones knew how to work with literature, and turn it into a legacy that is impossible to delete.

GUSTAVO GUICHÓN

Culture

The Payador's Inn (La Posada del Payador) is a cultural sanctuary dedicated to the life and legacy of Gustavo Guichón, one of Latin America's most revered payadores. Born in Uruguay, Guichón's music and poetry, rooted in the traditions of the payador, transcended borders, becoming a voice for the people. Known for his heartfelt improvisations and his solidarity with the humble, Guichón was not just a poet but a symbol of freedom, justice, and connection.

This House Museum celebrates his life through memorabilia, photos, and artifacts from his travels across Latin America and Europe. Visitors can explore the tools of his craft—his guitar, mate gourd, and poncho—and learn about his deep bond with the people he met along the way. The Payador's Inn is a place where the stories, values, and artistry of Gustavo Guichón live on, inspiring new generations to embrace the power of music, poetry, and human connection.



DESCENT OF THE VIRGIN

Culture

It is a religious and cultural celebration held in honour of the Virgin Mary, patroness of the locality. This event, of great significance for the community, involves the descent of the image of the Virgin from her hermitage or sacred place to the church or a central location in the town, where various religious activities take place, such as masses, processions, and prayers.



PATRON SAINT FESTIVITIES

Culture

These are religious and cultural celebrations held in honor of the saint or Virgin who is considered the patron of a town or city. These festivities are often deeply rooted in the traditions and customs of the community, and the date usually coincides with the day the Catholic Church commemorates the corresponding saint or Virgin.



MAY 25th

Culture

It is a local celebration commemorating the May Revolution of 1810: a key event in Argentina's history that marked the beginning of the country's independence process. This event is celebrated annually with great enthusiasm by the community of Villa de María del Río Seco.

During the parade, various local institutions participate, such as schools, community groups, and security forces, who march through the streets of the town in honor of the patriots and the ideals of freedom and autonomy that inspired the Revolution. Participants usually wear traditional costumes, historical uniforms, or folk attire that reflect the region's culture and history.



FESTIVAL OF SONG AND POETRY

Culture

This is a cultural event that celebrates the region's rich artistic tradition, especially focusing on folk music and poetry. This festival, held annually, is one of the most important events in the town, attracting both local artists and visitors from other parts of the country. During the festival, a series of performances take place featuring singers, poets, musicians, and folk groups who share their art in an atmosphere of celebration and tribute to regional culture.



WHAT TO DO

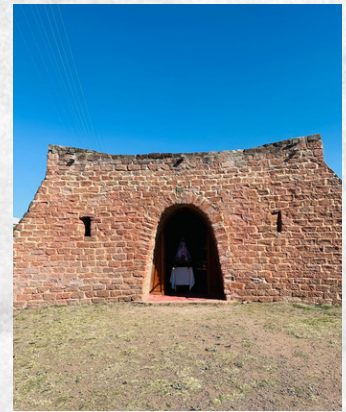
Tourism



NUESTRA SEÑORA DEL
ROSARIO SANCTUARY



LEOPOLDO LUGONES
MUSEUM



CERRO DEL ROMERO CHAPEL



ARCHAEOLOGICAL
MUSEUM



TOWN SQUARE



PAYADOR'S INN

WHERE TO STAY

Tourism



SAYR HOTEL



LAS TINAJAS HOTEL



LA DORADA INN

WHERE TO EAT

Tourism



YOLANDA
RESTAURANT-GRILL



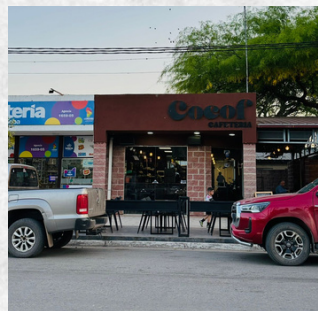
GITANA



RIZZUTO RESTAURANT



SULLAY BAKERY



COCOF-CAFÉ



PAN DE VIDA CAFÉ